

line small trash cans (one less item to buy), pick up after your dog in the park, or provide extra cushioning in those holiday postal packages.

10. Consider a personal filter for your kitchen faucet

This will enable you to skip the extra packaging that comes with large cases of bottled water, and carve some extra cash out of your personal budget at the same time. We've been using one for at least five or six years now and really like not having to find extra room for those bottles. — **Myscha Theriault**

7 Secrets to Gas-Efficient Driving

Your gas mileage depends more on the way you drive than on what car you are driving (of course, smaller is still better). Do you ever wonder why you don't seem to get the gas mileage that is advertised as the EPA rating for your car? Those tests are conducted under ideal conditions (weather, traffic, car condition) driven by an ideal driver. Most of us don't realize how much our driving

habits affect our mileage, and what little effort it takes to improve it significantly. Here are just a few tips to get better gas mileage, saving you money and helping our environment at the same time.

1. Inflate your tires

FuelEconomy.gov states that keeping tires inflated to the recommended pressure can improve fuel economy by up to 6%.

2. Stop aggressive driving

Speeding, cutting in and out of lanes, tailgating, and other smart-ass maneuvers save you very little time and end up costing you at the gas station. Don't floor your gas pedal when you start moving and slam on the brakes right in front of a red light. By anticipating stops and accelerating moderately, Edmunds.com found that you can get up to 37% in gas savings. This not only saves you gas, but also keeps your brake pads working longer and helps you avoid speeding tickets and accidents—not to mention it's better for your blood pressure!

3. Lower your highway speed

The biggest factor influencing fuel economy at high speeds is wind